THE HOLLOW HEIR

The Compendium

Every item, spell and condition, and every student at the table

For when a student holds something up and asks: “What does this do?”

Written by Zibby

Version 1.2

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PART 1

Things in the Bag

Potions, sweets and useful things. What they do and where they come from.

Students use these from their **Bag** on their phone. Anything that heals or restores is applied by the game straight away; anything else (a re-spin, a reminder, overhearing someone) is yours to play out.

Item	What it does	Where it comes from
Chocolate Frog	Heals 5 HP when used. Comes with a collectible card.	Shop: Sugarplum's Sweet Shop (1). Chests: Small chest
Pumpkin Pasty	Heals 3 HP when used.	Shop: Sugarplum's Sweet Shop (1). Chests: Small chest
Pepperup Potion	Heals 10 HP when used.	Shop: Slug and Jiggers Apothecary (5). Class: Day 1 Potions. Chests: Locked chest, Small chest
Wiggenweld Potion	Heals 20 HP when used.	Shop: Slug and Jiggers Apothecary (12). Class: Day 4 Potions. Chests: Ancient chest, Cursed chest, Locked chest
Focus Draught	Restores 10 mana when used.	Shop: Slug and Jiggers Apothecary (6). Chests: Ancient chest, Locked chest
Bertie Bott's Beans	Spin the bean wheel. Using it spins a wheel on the TV.	Shop: Sugarplum's Sweet Shop (1). Chests: Small chest
Felix Felicis	One free re-spin.	Chests: Ancient chest, Cursed chest
Remembrall	Ask the DM to remind you of one clue.	Shop: Weasleys' Wizard Wheezes (10). Chests: Locked chest
Extendable Ears	Overhear one private NPC conversation.	Shop: Weasleys' Wizard Wheezes (15). Chests: Locked chest
Creature treats	Calms one magical creature instantly.	Class: Day 3 Care of Magical Creatures

Keys, clues and story things

Answer these only for a student who has the thing in their Bag. They cannot be used up, and Peeves and the Hungry Trunk cannot take the important ones.

Item	What it is
Pocket Sneakoscope	Spins when someone nearby lies.
Mandrake leaf	Key ingredient in the draught that restores drained students.
Serpent key	Opens the door beneath Hogwarts. Only a Parseltongue can turn it.
Half of the Marauder's Map	Torn down the middle. It wakes only for the right words.
The other half of the Marauder's Map	Its torn edge matches the Fenwick half exactly.
Torn page about Corvin Vale	A painter who wanted to live forever.
Restorative Draught	Wakes one drained student.
Rare Chocolate Frog card	A collector would love this.
Scratched note (first ring)	"The first ring remembers what sleeps beneath the castle."

Item	What it is
Star chart (second ring)	“The second ring follows the lamp of the night.”
Feathered card (last ring)	“The last ring belongs to the one who carries every letter.”
Page of Vale’s diary	Written in runes. Collect all three.
Rune tablet (beasts and sky)	Pictures, each with a word in runes underneath.
Rune tablet (garden)	Pictures, each with a word in runes underneath.
Rune tablet (hearth)	Pictures, each with a word in runes underneath.
Stolen ingredient jars	Labelled in Grimsby’s spiky handwriting.

PART 2

Spells

Every spell a first-year can learn, how to roll it, and what it does.

How casting works: the student taps the spell on their Dice tab. It costs mana. An **attack** spell rolls d20 plus a stat against the target's Defence, then rolls damage on a hit. A **check** spell rolls d20 plus a stat against a difficulty you set (easy 10, medium 13, hard 16). A spell with **no roll** just works. Mana comes back after sleeping, or with a Focus Draught.

Spells taught in class

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Lumos	Light in the dark. Reveals invisible ink. 1 mana; no roll: it just works. Taught: Day 1 Charms.
Avifors	Turns a small object into a flock of birds. 2 mana; roll 1d4: rounds of distraction. Taught: Day 3 Transfiguration.
Alohomora	Unlocks a lock if your roll beats its difficulty. 2 mana; roll d20 + INT: it works if you beat the difficulty. Taught: Day 5 Charms.
Protego	Shield charm. Blocks damage from the next attack on you or an ally. 3 mana; roll 1d6: damage blocked. Taught: Day 5 Defence Against the Dark Arts.
Expelliarmus	Disarms the target. On a hit, their next attack misses. 3 mana; roll d20 + DEX to hit. Taught: Day 2 Defence Against the Dark Arts.
Stupefy	Stunning spell. 4 mana; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d8 damage.
Incendio	Conjures fire. Painted creatures burn. 5 mana; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d10 damage. Taught: Day 7 Transfiguration.

More charms and jinxes

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Wingardium Leviosa	Levitates an object. Heavier things need a higher roll. 2 mana; roll d20 + INT: it works if you beat the difficulty.
Accio	Summons an object you can name and see, or know is close. 3 mana; roll d20 + INT: it works if you beat the difficulty.
Reparo	Mends something broken. 1 mana; no roll: it just works.
Aguamenti	A jet of water. Puts out fires. 2 mana; no roll: it just works.
Finite Incantatem	Ends a spell or curse if the roll beats it. 2 mana; roll d20 + WIS: it works if you beat the difficulty.
Episkey	Heals small wounds on yourself or a friend. 3 mana; roll 1d6: HP healed (GM applies).
Flipendo	Knockback jinx. 2 mana; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d6 damage.
Rictusempra	Tickling charm. On a hit, the target loses its next turn laughing. 2 mana; roll d20 + CHA to hit; Stunned for 1 turn.

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Diffindo	Severing charm. Cuts ropes, vines and bags. 3 mana; roll d20 + DEX to hit; 1d6 damage.
Riddikulus	Turns fear into a joke. Only hurts Boggarts. 3 mana; roll d20 + CHA to hit; 1d10 damage; only works on boggart.
Silencio	On a hit, the target can't cast spells on its next turn. 3 mana; roll d20 + CHA to hit; Silenced for 1 turn.
Glacius	Freezing charm. 4 mana; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d8 damage.
Confundo	On a hit, the target attacks the wrong person next turn (GM decides). 4 mana; roll d20 + CHA to hit.
Immobulus	On a hit, freezes a creature in place for a round. 4 mana; roll d20 + WIS to hit; Stunned for 1 turn.
Petrificus Totalus	Full body-bind. On a hit, the target skips its next turn. 5 mana; roll d20 + INT to hit; Stunned for 1 turn.

Herbology spells (Green Thumb)

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Herbivicus	Makes a plant grow and bloom in moments: a vine to climb, a hedge to hide behind, roots to bridge a gap. Bigger plants need a higher roll. 2 mana; roll d20 + WIS: it works if you beat the difficulty.
Herba Sana	Coaxes a healing herb out of any soil. Whoever eats it heals. 3 mana; roll 1d6: HP healed (GM applies).
Radix Vincula	Roots burst out of the ground and grab the target. On a hit, it loses its next turn. 4 mana; level 2+; roll d20 + WIS to hit; Stunned for 1 turn.
Lumos Solem	A blaze of sunlight from the wand tip. Devil's Snare shrivels; it is harmless to everything else. 4 mana; level 3+; roll d20 + WIS to hit; 2d8 damage; only works on devils snare.

Advanced spells

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Bombarda	Explosive. Loud. Very loud. 7 mana; roll d20 + INT to hit; 2d8 damage.
Expecto Patronum	Your Patronus. Drives back dark creatures and Vale's servants. Advanced magic, usually learned in Year 3. 8 mana; roll d20 + WIS to hit; 1d12 damage.

Dark and forbidden magic

No first-year knows these. They come from forbidden books and dark mentors, most need a much higher level, and many cost Corruption. If a student asks, the honest answer is: “You have heard whispers. That is all.”

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Avada Kedavra	The Killing Curse. Kills any creature outright; bosses take 20. If anyone sees, you are expelled. 10 mana; roll d20 + CHA to hit; kills outright on a hit; +5 Corruption.
Sectumsempra	A slashing curse that carves deep wounds, as if by an unseen sword. Countered by Vulnera Sanentur. 7 mana; level 26+; roll d20 + INT to hit; 2d6 damage; Bleed for 3 turns; +2 Corruption. **Natural 20:** Bleed damage doubles (4/turn). **Natural 1:** Spell rebounds: caster takes Bleed for 3 turns. Learned from: Advanced Potion-Making (annotated), property of the half-blood prince.
Levicorpus	Hoists the target into the air by the ankle. They drop what they hold. Countered by Liberacorpus. 4 mana; level 21+; roll d20 + DEX to hit; Hung Upside Down for 1 turn. **Natural 20:** Target is hung for 2 turns. **Natural 1:** Caster is lifted instead. Learned from: Advanced Potion-Making (annotated), property of the half-blood prince.
Liberacorpus	Releases someone hung by Levicorpus. 2 mana; level 21+; no roll: it just works; cures Hung Upside Down; cast on a friend. Learned from: Advanced Potion-Making (annotated), property of the half-blood prince.
Langlock	Glues the target's tongue to the roof of their mouth. 4 mana; level 21+; roll d20 + CHA to hit; Silenced for 2 turns. **Natural 20:** Silence lasts 3 turns. **Natural 1:** Caster's own tongue sticks: silenced 1 turn. Learned from: Advanced Potion-Making (annotated), property of the half-blood prince.
Muffliato	Fills nearby ears with buzzing. NPCs cannot overhear the party; advantage on sneaking for the scene. 2 mana; level 21+; no roll: it just works. Learned from: Advanced Potion-Making (annotated), property of the half-blood prince.
Vulnera Sanentur	A sung counter-curse that knits dark-magic wounds closed. Rare — keep it hard to find. 5 mana; level 26+; roll 1d6: HP healed (GM applies); cures Bleed; cast on a friend; -1 Corruption. Learned from: Found in a rare tome.
Sanguis Vinculum	Blood Bond. The caster gives any amount of their own HP; an ally heals double. Love-magic, not dark. 3 mana; level 11+; no roll: it just works; cast on a friend; you choose how much HP to give; heals 2x HP sacrificed. Learned from: Taught by a teacher or mentor.
Cruor Haurire	Blood Leech. Draws blood from the target to mend the caster. 4 mana; level 16+; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d6 damage; heals you 50% of the damage; +1 Corruption. **Natural 20:** Caster heals the full damage dealt. **Natural 1:** Caster loses 2 HP. Learned from: Taught by a teacher or mentor.
Sanguis Revelio	Reveals blood trails, hidden wounds and blood-sealed doors. Use for tracking and puzzles. 2 mana; level 6+; no roll: it just works. Learned from: Taught by a teacher or mentor.
Clipeus Cruoris	Blood Shield. Spend 3 HP to fully block the next incoming hit. 3 mana; level 16+; no roll: it just works; costs 3 HP; +1 Corruption. Learned from: Taught by a teacher or mentor.
Confringo	Blasting curse. Explodes on impact, splashing 2 damage to anything adjacent. 5 mana; level 16+; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d8 damage; Burning for 2 turns (natural 20 only). **Natural 20:** Target also catches fire (Burning, 2 turns). **Natural 1:** Explodes at the caster's feet: 2 damage to caster. Learned from: Taught by a teacher or mentor.
Expulso	An explosive blast that hurls the target backward — into walls, hazards or off ledges. 4 mana; level 11+; roll d20 + INT to hit; 1d6 damage. **Natural 20:** Knockback into a hazard deals +1d6. **Natural 1:** Caster is knocked back instead. Learned from: Taught by a teacher or mentor.
Morsmordre	Conjures the Dark Mark. Enemies roll at disadvantage from fear. 6 mana; level 26+; no roll: it just works; Fear for 1 turn; hits every enemy in the room; +1 Corruption. **Natural 20:** Fear lasts 2 turns. **Natural 1:** The party is frightened instead. Learned from: Found in a dark tome.

Spell	What it does and how to roll it
Fiendfyre	Cursed, living fire. Devastating, but the caster must roll to keep control every turn. 9 mana; level 31+; roll 3d6: damage to everything caught in it (GM applies); +2 Corruption. **Natural 1:** Instantly out of control. Learned from: Found in a dark tome.

PART 3

Conditions

What happens when a spell or a creature leaves its mark.

Condition	What it does
Bleed	2 damage every turn; lasts 3 turns.
Stunned	skips their turn.
Silenced	cannot cast spells.
Fear	rolls with disadvantage.
Hung Upside Down	skips their turn; drops what they are holding.
Burning	2 damage every turn; lasts 2 turns.
Cruciatus	1d4 damage every turn; skips their turn; lasts until someone ends it.
Imperius	someone else controls them.
Blood Shield	blocks the next 1 hit.

PART 4

Checks

Every kind of roll you might ask for, which stat it uses, and what makes a student better at it.

How a check works

When a student tries something that could fail, ask for a check. They roll a **d20 plus one stat bonus** on the **Dice** tab (pick d20, then the stat), and the result appears on the TV. Meet or beat the difficulty and it works.

Difficulty	Number	For example
Very easy	5	Remembering a professor's name, climbing a low wall
Easy	10	Sneaking past a dozing portrait, calming a nervous owl
Medium	13	Picking a lock, lying to a prefect, finding a book fast
Hard	16	Sneaking past Filch, reading an ancient rune
Very hard	19	Lying to the Headmaster, outrunning a Thornback Boar

- **Advantage:** roll two d20s, keep the higher. Give it when something helps: a good plan, the right spell, a friend helping, the right family gift.
- **Disadvantage:** roll two, keep the lower. Give it when something hinders: darkness, panic, Fear, a broken wand.
- **Natural 20:** something wonderful. **Natural 1:** something disastrous (and funny).
- **The stat bonus** on the phone already includes everything: the family's stats, the house bonus, the wand, the familiar and the books. The **MVP Badge** adds +2 more on top.

The checks

This game only has six stats. Every "skill" from other tabletop games is just one of them. Say the name of the check (it sounds more exciting), and the student rolls the stat beside it.

Check	Stat	When to ask for it	What makes them better
Perception	WIS	Noticing something hidden: a trap, a secret door, footsteps behind them, a chest that is breathing.	Cat or Kneazle (+1 WIS), Holly wand (+1 WIS). The Okafor is warned of traps and curses before anyone rolls.
Insight	WIS	Is this person lying? Are they scared? What do they want?	Kneazle (senses untrustworthy people), a Pocket Sneakoscope (spins when someone lies).
Animal handling	WIS	Calming, befriending or riding a creature.	Creature treats calm one instantly. The Thornbury talks to rats; the Penrose has a suitcase full of creatures.
Herbology	WIS	Handling, naming or calming a plant.	The Fenwick (Green Thumb) rolls with advantage.
Investigation	INT	Searching a room or a desk properly, piecing clues together.	Ravenclaw (+2 INT), Owl (+1 INT), New or Annotated books (+1 INT).
Knowledge	INT	Remembering a fact: a creature's weakness, a spell, a bit of castle history.	Same as Investigation. A Remembrall reminds them of one clue.

Check	Stat	When to ask for it	What makes them better
Sense magic	INT	Feeling an enchantment, a curse or a hidden spell on something.	The Okafor (Curse-Breaker) feels curses without rolling. The Quill (The Sight) can ask what here is hidden or enchanted, once a day.
Potion-making	INT	Brewing, or naming a potion by its smell.	A Brass cauldron (an extra spin), a Gold cauldron (an extra dose).
Stealth	DEX	Sneaking past someone, hiding, moving after curfew.	Rat, Bowtruckle or Niffler (+1 DEX). The Invisibility Cloak needs no roll at all.
Sleight of hand	DEX	Lifting a key, swapping an item, picking a lock, palming a card.	Bowtruckle (picks simple locks). The cloak gives advantage.
Acrobatics	DEX	Dodging, balancing, jumping between moving staircases.	DEX familiars (+1 DEX).
Athletics	STR	Climbing, forcing a door, holding on, swimming, wrestling something off a friend.	Gryffindor (+2 STR).
Endurance	CON	Resisting poison, cold, a Mandrake's scream, a curse; staying awake; drinking something awful.	Hufflepuff (+2 CON).
Persuasion	CHA	Talking a teacher round, getting a favour, making a deal.	Slytherin (+2 CHA), Kneazle (+1 CHA), Yew wand (+1 CHA).
Deception	CHA	Lying, bluffing Filch, forging a story.	Same as Persuasion. Careful: the Penrose's hair changes colour when they lie.
Intimidation	CHA	Scaring Peeves, a younger student, or a creature off.	Same as Persuasion.
Opening a chest	DEX or INT	Small, Locked and Cursed chests use DEX; Ancient chests use INT (Part 6).	The Okafor rolls with advantage. Slytherins find half as much gold again.

The Dreadful Roll

The best trick in tabletop gaming. Just before a student does something ordinary (opens a chest, drinks a potion, sits down, picks something up), you stop them and say, very calmly: **"Before you do that… roll me a Perception check."** They roll. You look at the number. You write it down. You say "Okay." And nothing else.

- **Do it on safe things too.** At least two times out of three, nothing is wrong at all. That is the whole trick: they can never tell which time is real.
- **Never explain.** Write the number down, nod slowly, maybe say "Hm." Do not answer "why?"
- **Be fair when it is real.** When there really is a mimic or a trap, a good roll gets a real warning (see the table). A bad roll gets nothing, and then the lid opens.
- **Once or twice a session** is plenty. More than that and it stops being scary.

You ask for	Just before	If something IS wrong (13 or more)	If nothing is wrong
Perception (WIS)	Opening a chest	"The keyhole… blinks." (A mimic.) Or: "There is a needle in the lock, glistening." (A trap.)	"It is a chest." Pause. "Probably."
Perception (WIS)	Picking up a Mandrake leaf (Day 2)	"The leaf is… breathing." (The Wailing Mandrake.)	"It is a leaf. A very good leaf."
Endurance (CON)	Drinking a potion or eating a sweet	"It tastes of pennies and something worse." They know before it hits.	"Delicious." Then, very quietly: "…for now."
Insight (WIS)	Accepting a teacher's kind offer	"His smile stays a moment too long."	"He seems nice." Write something down.

You ask for	Just before	If something IS wrong (13 or more)	If nothing is wrong
Stealth (DEX)	Walking down an empty corridor	“You hear a second set of footsteps stop when yours do.”	“Nobody sees you.” Look at the portraits on the wall. Say nothing.
Everyone: initiative	Nothing at all	A fight really starts.	Write all the numbers down. Wait. Then Peeves drops a water balloon. Use this once a campaign.

TIP

A great variation: “Who has the highest Perception here?” Let them work it out (it is the Thornbury or the Quill). Then: “Just you. Come here.” Whisper something harmless to them. Send them back. Say nothing to the others.

Who is best at what (this party)

Their bonuses on 12 November, with house, wand, familiar and books included. Buying new gear changes these; the Players tab always shows the real numbers.

Student	STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
Blackwood (Ash)	+0	+0	+1	+3	+1	+2
Fenwick (Arthur)	+0	+2	+2	+2	-1	+2
Okafor (Inzaw)	+0	+1	+2	+2	+1	+0
Penrose (Cass)	-1	+2	+0	+1	+0	+4
Quill (Danny)	-1	+1	+0	+3	+2	+2
Sinclair (Rose)	+2	+1	+2	+3	+0	-1
Thornbury (John)	+1	+0	+2	+1	+2	+1

For	Stat	Best in the party
Perception, Insight, creatures, plants	WIS	Quill, Thornbury (+2)
Investigation, Knowledge, Sense magic	INT	Blackwood, Quill, Sinclair (+3)
Stealth, Sleight of hand, Acrobatics	DEX	Fenwick, Penrose (+2)
Athletics	STR	Sinclair (+2)
Endurance	CON	Fenwick, Okafor, Sinclair, Thornbury (+2)
Persuasion, Deception, Intimidation	CHA	Penrose (+4)

PART 5

Shops and gear

What things cost and what they give. Gear is worn from the Bag and its bonus counts all the time.

Madam Malkin's Robes

Item	Price	What it gives
Second-hand robes	3 Galleons	Patched but wearable
Standard school robes	8 Galleons	+1 Defence
Tailored robes	30 Galleons	+2 Defence
Dragonhide-lined robes	90 Galleons	+3 Defence, +4 max HP

Magical Menagerie

Item	Price	What it gives
Toad	4 Galleons	+2 max HP. Hops off at the worst moments
Rat	6 Galleons	+1 DEX. Squeezes through gaps to scout
Cat	15 Galleons	+1 WIS. Hisses at hidden danger
Owl	25 Galleons	+1 INT. Delivers items to anyone, anywhere
Bowtruckle	40 Galleons	+1 DEX, +1 Defence. Picks simple locks
Kneazle	60 Galleons	+1 WIS, +1 CHA. Senses untrustworthy people
Niffler	120 Galleons	+1 DEX. Sniffs out hidden treasure and Galleons

Potage's Cauldron Shop

Item	Price	What it gives
Pewter cauldron	3 Galleons	Standard size 2. Required for Potions
Brass cauldron	12 Galleons	Brews faster: one extra wheel spin in Potions
Gold cauldron	50 Galleons	Potions you brew make one extra dose

Flourish and Blotts

Item	Price	What it gives
Used book set	3 Galleons	Scribbled notes. Required to learn spells
New book set	9 Galleons	+1 INT
Annotated book set	35 Galleons	+1 INT, +1 spell damage. Margin notes by a famous witch

Weasleys' Wizard Wheezes

Item	Price	What it gives
Extendable Ears	15 Galleons	Overhear one private NPC conversation.
Remembrall	10 Galleons	Ask the DM to remind you of one clue.
Pocket Sneakoscope	30 Galleons	Spins when someone nearby lies.

Sugarplum's Sweet Shop

Item	Price	What it gives
Chocolate Frog	1 Galleons	Heals 5 HP when used. Comes with a collectible card.
Bertie Bott's Beans	1 Galleons	Spin the bean wheel. Using it spins a wheel on the TV.
Pumpkin Pasty	1 Galleons	Heals 3 HP when used.

Slug and Jiggers Apothecary

Item	Price	What it gives
Pepperup Potion	5 Galleons	Heals 10 HP when used.
Focus Draught	6 Galleons	Restores 10 mana when used.
Wiggenweld Potion	12 Galleons	Heals 20 HP when used.

PART 6

Chests

What is inside, and how hard they are to open.

Chest	To open	Galleons	Items inside
Small chest	DEX 8	3 to 10	1 of: Chocolate Frog, Pumpkin Pasty, Bertie Bott's Beans, Pepperup Potion
Locked chest	DEX 13	10 to 25	2 of: Pepperup Potion, Focus Draught, Wiggenweld Potion, Remembrall, Extendable Ears
Ancient chest	INT 16	25 to 60	2 of: Wiggenweld Potion, Felix Felicis, Pocket Sneakoscope, Focus Draught, Rare Chocolate Frog card
Cursed chest	DEX 14	20 to 40	1 of: Felix Felicis, Wiggenweld Potion, Pocket Sneakoscope. **Trapped:** 4 damage if the roll fails.

ON THE GM SCREEN

A natural 20 on a chest: give the most Galleons and the best items on its list. **A natural 1**: the lid snaps shut on their fingers (1 HP) and it stays locked until tomorrow.

Bertie Bott's Every Flavour Beans

Eating them spins this wheel on the TV:

Flavour	What happens
Chocolate	Chocolate! Delicious. +2 HP
Earwax	Earwax. Everyone watches you gag
Toffee	Toffee! +2 HP
Vomit	Vomit flavour. −2 HP
Pepper	Pepper! You breathe smoke. +2 mana
Bogey	Bogey. You swallow it anyway
Grass	Freshly cut grass. Oddly nice
Cherry	Cherry! +2 HP

PART 7

The students

One page for each student at your table: what their family ability and secret gift do, how to rule them in the moment, and who they are.

How their powers work

Every student has three things on top of their rolls. Each of them recharges when the student sleeps (the start of a new day).

What	Who knows	How they use it	What you do
Family ability	Everyone. It is on their phone and their family is famous for it.	They tap **Use** on their phone. It is announced on the TV and greys out until tomorrow.	Make it happen, big and out loud. The rulings on their page help.
Secret gift	Only them and you. Nobody at Hogwarts knows.	They tell you quietly, or show you the card on their phone.	Tick **Used today** on the Players tab. Describe it to them alone if you can (a note, a whisper, a text).
House trait	Everyone.	Gryffindor and Slytherin traits happen by themselves. Ravenclaws tap **Ask for a hint**; Hufflepuffs are saved by the app.	Give the Ravenclaw hint when asked. Describe the Hufflepuff save dramatically.

Ruling a power you did not plan for

- **Say yes, then add a cost.** If the use is clever, let it work. If it is too strong, let it work and add a small price: noise, a witness, a point lost, a favour owed.
- **The "always" part never needs a roll.** The Okafor feels a curse, the Quill sees through a disguise, the Thornbury is never attacked first by a creature. Just tell them.
- **The once-a-day part beats a roll.** When they spend it, it works. Do not make them roll for something they paid for.
- **Drawbacks are gifts to you.** Use one each session per student. They make the best stories, and the players chose them knowing.
- **Answers from creatures, plants and portraits** are short and in character: feelings, images, three or four words. Never a full paragraph of plot.
- **Protect the mystery.** No power reveals who the Hollow Heir is, or what the covered painting holds, before Day 4. Powers find clues; they do not skip the story.

Today's checklist

Student	Morning roll	Once a day (family)	Once a day (secret)
Blackwood		One true answer from a portrait	Ask the spiders what they saw (costs food)
Fenwick		Open the map for 60 seconds	Ask a plant for help
Okafor		Break one curse, ward or trap	Wear the cloak for one scene
Penrose	d20: 1 to 4, something escaped the suitcase	Wear someone's face for one scene	Let one creature out of the suitcase
Quill		Ask: what here is hidden or enchanted?	Send the Mirror Self for one scene

Student	Morning roll	Once a day (family)	Once a day (secret)
Sinclair	d20: 1 to 6, late for morning class	Re-roll one d20 in a fight	Burst into a scene already started
Thornbury		Ask a creature what it has seen	Send a rat to listen for one block

Ash Blackwood

Played by Ashwin Singh. Gryffindor. Pureblood, an overflowing vault.

Rolls	STR +0 · DEX +0 · CON +1 · INT +3 · WIS +1 · CHA +2
HP	24 at full health
Carries	Vine wand with a phoenix feather core (+1 spell damage). Dragonhide-lined robes (+3 Defence, +4 max HP). A Niffler (+1 DEX, sniffs out treasure). Annotated books. A Pocket Sneakoscope. The second ring's star chart.
House trait	**Nerve.** +2 STR (already in the numbers). Once a day, the first natural 1 they roll is re-rolled by itself. The app does it; you will see it on the TV.

Family ability: Portrait Whisperer

Always	Portraits recognise the Blackwood name and talk to them freely, when they would ignore any other student.
Once a day	Ask any portrait one question. It must answer truthfully.
Drawback	Portraits gossip. When the Blackwood breaks a rule near one, spin (or roll a d20; 1 to 8) to see if a teacher hears about it.

When they use it:

They ask a portrait anything, any time (no power used)	It answers politely, but it can lie, flatter or change the subject. Portraits love the Blackwood name. Use them for directions, castle gossip, and who walked past.
They use the power: one true question	The portrait must answer truthfully, but only what it saw or knows, in its own words. A portrait that saw nothing says so. Good questions get great answers.
Best use (Day 3)	A portrait in the library corridor, asked what it saw: it answers, terrified, "A painted man. Climbing out."
They ask about the covered painting	Every portrait in the castle goes silent at once. One whispers: "We do not speak of the guest." That is the true answer: they are afraid.
They ask who the Hollow Heir is	Before Day 4: "The one who wears the faces." True, and useless until later.
They break a rule near a portrait	Roll a d20 for the gossip: 1 to 8, a teacher hears by the next block (−5 house points, or a teacher "just happens" to pass). A Blackwood with a pastry for the portrait can buy its silence.

Secret gift: Spider-Speech

Always	They understand the spiders in every corner of the castle, and the spiders understand them. Spiders notice everything.
Once a day	Ask the spiders in a room what they saw there since yesterday. The answer is a few short, whispery words.
Drawback	Spiders want paying: one food item from the Bag, or they ignore the Blackwood until tomorrow. And they will not go anywhere near the covered painting.

When they use it:

They ask the spiders (once a day)	Take a food item off them (pumpkin pasty, chocolate frog, beans). Then answer in four or five whispered words: “Two came. Red cloth. Downstairs.” Keep it short and creepy-funny.
They try without food	Silence. Then, much later, a single word: “Rude.”
Near the covered painting	The spiders have fled the room. That empty corner is the answer: something there frightens even them.
They share food with the table first (Day 1)	It still counts as the payment if the spiders saw them do it. Spiders like generosity.
In a fight	Spiders cannot fight for them. They can warn: “Behind you.” Give advantage on the next defence roll, once.

Who they are

One of the oldest wizarding families in Britain. Portraits of Blackwoods line every wall of the family manor, and all of them have opinions about Ash. A Gryffindor in a family of mostly Slytherins, which the portraits at home have not stopped talking about.

The family secret: Grandmother’s diary mentions “the painted man” and a debt the Blackwoods never paid. Centuries ago, a Blackwood sealed a dark wizard inside a painting. That wizard is Vale.

So far: On Day 1 Ash used the spiders, shared pumpkin pasties with the others, and found the star chart for the second ring.

Where their story goes:

- When the name **Vale** appears (Day 4), the Blackwood recognises it from grandmother’s diary. Let them be the one who says the debt out loud.
- An owl from home (any day): a portrait at the manor has been turned to face the wall, and nobody will say why.
- The covered painting knows the Blackwood name too. Up close, it says “Blackwood” in a voice like a smile. Only they hear it.

Playing to them: Old-family confidence, a bit of a show-off. Let portraits treat them like a celebrity, and let that go to their head before it gets them in trouble.

IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS

“Master Blackwood! Your great-great-uncle owed me four Sickles. I suppose it would be vulgar to mention it.”

Arthur Fenwick

Played by Captain Neo. Hufflepuff. Half-blood, a healthy vault.

Rolls	STR +0 · DEX +2 · CON +2 · INT +2 · WIS −1 · CHA +2
HP	20 at full health
Carries	Oak wand with a unicorn hair core (+1 STR, +4 mana). An Owl (+1 INT, delivers items). Annotated books. A Gold cauldron (an extra dose of every potion). Half of the Marauder's Map. A Pocket Sneakoscope.
House trait	**Steadfast.** +2 CON (already in the numbers). Once a day, a hit that would knock them out leaves them on 1 HP instead. Describe it: they should have gone down, and they did not.

Family ability: Marauder's Legacy

Always	Their great-uncle ran with the Marauders and left them his half of the map. It wakes only for the right words. Tiny runes are scratched along its torn edge.
Once a day	Open the map from the Bag: say the words into the phone, and the whole table sees everyone's footsteps and every treasure on their half of the castle for 60 seconds.
Drawback	Half the map is missing and the ink fades fast. Finding the other half is a side quest only they know about.

When they use it:

They open the map (once a day)	The TV shows the footsteps for 60 seconds. Make the room go quiet. Let the table shout what they see; do not explain it for them.
They read something odd on it	Footsteps where nobody should be. Two sets of footsteps with the same name. Treat anything strange as a real clue.
Somebody is under the Invisibility Cloak	The map still shows them. A lovely moment if the Okafor is sneaking.
A teacher sees the map (as on Day 1)	It shows blank parchment to anyone else. A teacher who has seen one before narrows their eyes: "Mischief managed, I hope." They remember the Fenwick from now on.
They look for the other half	Cassius has it (Day 4, Lunch, the Courtyard). Before then: footsteps on the map stop at the torn edge and carry on off it.

Secret gift: Green Thumb

Always	Plants like them. They know any plant on sight (what it does and whether it bites), roll with advantage in Herbology, and can learn Herbology spells nobody else is taught.
Once a day	Ask a plant for help: a vine lowers itself for them to climb, a hedge parts, a Mandrake stays quiet, or the grass tells them who walked past.
Drawback	Plants feel what they feel. When the Fenwick is angry or frightened, the plants around them go wild. And Devil's Snare always grabs them first.

When they use it:

They ask a plant for help (once a day)	It works. The plant answers in movements and feelings: the grass flattens toward the lake, a vine shivers when a name is said.
Day 2: the Wailing Mandrake	Their gift is the best tool here. Asked, the real Mandrakes go quiet and lean away from one pot. That pot is the mimic.
Mandrake Repotting (Day 2 class)	Advantage on their rolls. If they calm a Mandrake for the whole class, give the class +5 points.

They are angry or scared near plants	Roots heave, a vine knocks something over, a Venomous Tentacula leans over. Funny first, dangerous only in a real fight.
Devil's Snare (Day 3 onwards)	It grabs them first, every time. The table has to save them (Lumos or a fire spell).
They make friends with ghosts (Day 1, Borish)	Not a plant thing, but in keeping: the Fenwick is the one creatures and spirits trust. Borish follows them, rolling a d20 for legendary finds.

Who they are

The family runs Fenwick's Fizzing Follies, a joke shop on Diagon Alley. Arthur grew up testing products nobody else would touch, and the Fenwicks have always been on the edge of trouble, and on the side of the people in it.

The family secret: Their great-uncle copied the Marauder's Map before he was expelled, and it was torn in half in a duel. Someone at Hogwarts has the other half, and they have been watching the Fenwick.

So far: On Day 1 Arthur tried politely talking to Peeves (who vanished), made friends with the ghost Borish, and a professor noticed his map. He can read the Marauder's words.

Where their story goes:

- The professor who saw the map remembers it. Pay it off with a quiet word on Day 3: "Your great-uncle sat in that very seat. He was expelled, you know."
- Cassius holds the other half (Day 4). When the halves meet, both maps show the whole castle, and the footsteps of someone who is not on any register.
- Borish: let his legendary d20 rolls turn up one real clue before Day 4 (an old map fragment, a key, a page).

Playing to them: A good-natured prankster who is kinder than he lets on. Reward the polite approach, even when it backfires.

> **IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS**
>
> *"A Fenwick! Is the joke shop still open? Your grandfather sold me a quill that wrote only insults. I loved it."*

Inzaw Okafor

Played by Tarek. Hufflepuff. Half-blood, a healthy vault.

Rolls	STR +0 · DEX +1 · CON +2 · INT +2 · WIS +1 · CHA +0
HP	20 at full health
Carries	Ash wand with a unicorn hair core (loyal for life, +4 mana). A Kneazle (+1 WIS, +1 CHA, senses untrustworthy people). Used books. The Invisibility Cloak. MVP of Day 1.
House trait	**Steadfast.** +2 CON (already in the numbers). Once a day, a hit that would knock them out leaves them on 1 HP instead. Describe it: they should have gone down, and they did not.

Family ability: Curse-Breaker

Always	They feel curses, wards and traps before they trigger them: you warn them when one is close. Advantage on opening locked or cursed chests.
Once a day	Break one curse, ward or magical trap outright: a cursed chest opens safely, a hex fades, a trap fizzles. It cannot solve a puzzle lock or wake a drained student.
Drawback	Curses bite back. Each time they break one, spin (or roll a d20): sometimes a little of it sticks to them.

When they use it:

They come near a curse, ward or trap	Tell them before they touch it, no roll: “Your fingertips go cold. Something here does not want to be opened.” This is the “always” part.
They break one (once a day)	It works, no roll. Then roll a d20 for the bite-back: 1 to 5, a little sticks (1d4 damage, or a status for a turn: Fear, Silence, a Jinx). 6 to 20, nothing.
A cursed or locked chest	Advantage on the roll to open it, every time, without using the power. Spend the power only on a chest that would hurt them.
The Restricted Section gate (Day 2)	The keys are with the Headmaster and the librarian, but the lock is warded. He can break the ward. The gate swings open. Once a day: it uses today’s power.
A puzzle lock or a drained student	It does not work: those are not curses. Tell them clearly so they do not feel cheated: “There is nothing to break. It is a riddle, not a hex.”
The covered painting (Day 4)	They feel exactly what their mother felt: something inside, awake, pressing back. They can break the outer ward, but the thing inside stays. Do not let one roll end the story.

Secret gift: The Invisibility Cloak

Always	They own a real Invisibility Cloak, silvery and light as water. Under it, nobody can see them.
Once a day	Wear it for one scene a day. Unseen, they can slip past anyone; in a fight their first attack has advantage (after that, everyone knows where they are).
Drawback	It hides them, not sound, smell or footprints. The Marauder’s Map still shows them, creatures smell them, ghosts walk straight through, and the Quill’s Sight sees a shimmer. Two can hide under it only if both pass a DEX roll. A teacher who catches them takes it for a week.

When they use it:

They wear it (once a day, one scene)	No Stealth roll to be unseen. Ask for a roll only for noise (DEX 10 to walk quietly past a sleeping guard; 14 past Filch).
Day 1: into the Restricted Section	He got past the librarian, but the gate was locked. That is fair: the cloak hides, it does not open.

Two under the cloak	Both roll DEX 12. One fails: a foot shows, a sneeze, an elbow. Everyone nearby gets a Perception roll.
Creatures, Mrs Norris, ghosts	Creatures smell them (Mrs Norris stares at empty air and yowls). Ghosts drift through them, shivering. Use it for comedy.
A teacher catches them	The cloak is confiscated for a week. Write it in the GM notes. A clever plan to get it back is a whole side quest.
In a fight	First attack with advantage, then they are seen. One scene only.

Who they are

Their mum breaks curses on ancient tombs for Gringotts, and their dad is a Muggle engineer who still cannot quite believe any of it. Inzaw has been picking enchanted locks since he was six. Day 1's MVP, and the student the others look to when something is locked.

The family secret: Last month Gringotts sent their mum to inspect a painting before it was shipped to Hogwarts. She refused to unwrap it and wrote one word in her report: **Occupied**. It was sent anyway.

So far: MVP of Day 1. He wore the cloak into the Restricted Section, got past the librarian but not the gate. His diary guessed that the mirror holds an item that needs all the houses together (right: the Silver Memory), and that a forbidden spell sits behind three puzzles of runes (half right: the tablets).

Where their story goes:

- He returns to the Restricted Section with Curse-Breaker (Day 2) and breaks the ward. Inside, the chained books: a d6 each (Day 2 Book).
- An owl from his mum (Day 3): "Did they hang it? Do NOT touch it. Promise me." He will touch it.
- Day 4: hand on the covered painting. Read him the feeling privately, then let him tell the table in his own words.

Playing to them: Practical and brave; he likes being the expert. Give him locks, wards and chests, and let him explain to the others how curses work.

IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS

"Careful, young man. That door bites. Oh, it is you. Then the door had better be careful."

Cass Penrose

Played by TheWhoWot. Slytherin. Half-blood, a healthy vault.

Rolls	STR −1 · DEX +2 · CON +0 · INT +1 · WIS +0 · CHA +4
HP	18 at full health
Carries	Hawthorn wand with a unicorn hair core (quick but hard to master, +4 mana). A Cat (+1 WIS, hisses at hidden danger). New books. The battered suitcase.
House trait	**Cunning.** +2 CHA (already in the numbers). Every chest they open gives half as much gold again. The app adds it.

Family ability: Metamorphmagus

Always	They can change hair, eyes and face at will. Advantage on rolls to avoid being recognised or blamed.
Once a day	Take on the face of someone they have seen, for one scene. Only their voice and wand can give them away.
Drawback	Strong feelings show. When they are frightened, angry or lying, their hair changes colour, and you tell the table.

When they use it:

Small changes, any time (no power used)	Hair, eyes, a different nose: free. Advantage to slip away from a teacher who saw “someone” do it.
A whole face (once a day, one scene)	It works. Nobody sees through it by looking. The voice gives them away: if they speak to someone who knows the real person well, that person rolls Insight (WIS 13).
A prefect’s face, to get somewhere	Classic and great. Into the Restricted Section, the prefects’ bathroom, past a portrait guard. Let a good plan beat a roll.
Filch’s face, to scare Peeves	Peeves flees, then comes back with the real Filch. Pure chaos; give it.
They lie, or are scared or angry	Say out loud: “Cass’s hair has just gone bright yellow.” (Red for anger, white for fear, yellow for lying.) Every time, it is the best drawback in the game.
They copy the Headmaster or Ashgrove	It works, but the Sorting Hat, the Quill’s Sight and the covered painting see through any face. The painting likes them for it: “A face-changer. How useful.”

Secret gift: The Battered Suitcase

Always	An old suitcase with the initials N.S. worn into the handle. Inside is a whole world of magical creatures, and they let the Penrose in.
Once a day	Let one creature out to help for a scene: a Niffler sniffs out something shiny or hidden, a Bowtruckle picks a small lock, or an Occamy squeezes into any gap to fetch something.
Drawback	Things get out. Each morning roll a d20: on 1 to 4 something escaped in the night and is causing chaos somewhere. Catch it before a teacher does, or the case is confiscated. Professor Scamander would very much like to know where they got it.

When they use it:

A Niffler	Finds one shiny or hidden thing in the room: a coin, a key, a loose stone with something behind it. Then it tries to keep it (DEX 10 to get it back).
A Bowtruckle	Picks one small, ordinary lock. Not a warded or cursed one (that is the Okafor’s job), and not a puzzle.

An Occamy	Squeezes into any gap to fetch one thing it can carry. It grows to fill the space, so getting it back out is funny.
The morning roll (1 to 4)	Use the d4 table in that day's Day Book. Tell the Penrose privately. If it is not caught by Curfew, the case is confiscated for a few days.
Scamander sees the case (Day 3, Care of Magical Creatures)	"Where did you get that? I have only ever seen one like it." Do not answer for them. Let them choose how much to say.

Who they are

A noisy Cornish family who run a wizarding theatre in Penzance. Half the relatives can change their faces, and family photos are a nightmare. Cass is the actor of the table: watchful, funny, and always half in costume.

The family secret: Their great-great-grandmother sat for a famous portrait painter and came home unable to change her face ever again. The painting was never delivered, and nobody knows where it went. It is one of Vale's.

So far: On Day 1 Cass opened the Astronomy Tower chest (20 Galleons, a Focus Draught and a Wiggenweld). Their diary noticed the painting being moved to the Dungeons under a red cloth, guessed that the stolen boomslang skin and lacewing flies mean Polyjuice, wondered if Scamander is related, and noted that "Boris's" ghost finds hidden items.

Where their story goes:

- The Polyjuice guess: let them keep it. On Day 4, when the Painted Double appears, they will feel they called it (and they half did).
- Day 4: a new painting by the door of Ashgrove's classroom. A young woman in old clothes, her face frozen. It is the great-great-grandmother.
- N.S. on the suitcase: the Scamander link pays off on Day 3. What it means for the family is yours to decide later.

Playing to them: Theatrical, loves a disguise and a lie. Make the hair colour a running joke the table waits for.

IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS

"Have we met? You look like someone. You look like everyone, actually. How tiring for you."

Danny Quill

Played by Daniel Nand. Ravenclaw. Muggle-born, the Hogwarts school fund.

Rolls	STR −1 · DEX +1 · CON +0 · INT +3 · WIS +2 · CHA +2
HP	18 at full health
Carries	Yew wand with a dragon heartstring core (chooses the strong-willed, +2 spell damage). A Rat (+1 DEX, squeezes through gaps). Used books.
House trait	**Wit.** +2 INT (already in the numbers). Once a day they can tap **Ask for a hint** on a puzzle, and you give one. A hint is a nudge, not the answer: point at the right object, or confirm one letter.

Family ability: The Sight

Always	They see through disguises, glamours and magical illusions that fool everyone else.
Once a day	Ask the DM: “What here is hidden or enchanted?” and get an honest answer.
Drawback	Visions come uninvited. Sometimes you show them something they would rather not have seen.

When they use it:

A disguise, glamour or illusion (no power used)	They just see through it. The Penrose in someone else’s face, a mimic pretending to be a chest, the Painted Double: tell the Quill privately what they really see.
They ask: what here is hidden or enchanted? (once a day)	Answer honestly and specifically for this room: “The third book on that shelf. The window latch. And the painting, all of it.”
Best use (Ashgrove’s classroom)	“Every painting. All of them.” Let it land. Say nothing more.
An uninvited vision	Once a session, at a quiet moment, pass them a note: a painted eye opening, a staircase that goes down forever, a girl with grey skin. Clues, but frightening ones.
The Invisibility Cloak	They see a shimmer where the Okafor is. Fun when the table is trying to sneak.

Secret gift: Mirror Self

Always	They can make a magical illusion of themselves. It looks, moves and smiles like them, but it cannot speak or touch anything.
Once a day	For one scene, send the illusion somewhere they are not: as a decoy, an alibi, or to walk into danger first. In a fight, the first attack that would hit them hits the illusion instead, and it pops.
Drawback	While it is up they cannot cast spells. If it is hit or touched it bursts, and they feel it: 1d4 damage. And something else in this castle copies people. It has noticed them.

When they use it:

As a decoy or an alibi	It works until someone touches it or speaks to it and waits for an answer. A teacher who sees it “in class” while the Quill is elsewhere is fooled, for the scene.
Walking into danger first	Traps fire on it, mimics bite it, monsters chase it. It bursts: 1d4 damage to the Quill, and they learn what was there.
In a fight	The first attack that would hit them hits the illusion. No spells while it is up: they choose when to let it go.
The Painted Double notices (Day 3 onwards)	Once, the Double copies the Quill. Two Quills in a corridor. Only the real one cannot see through itself. Tell them privately and watch them try to prove who they are.

Who they are

Until their letter came, Danny thought the strange things around him were coincidences. His parents are dentists, thrilled and terrified in equal measure. Everything at Hogwarts is new to him, which makes him the one who asks the questions everyone else forgot to.

The family secret: On the train he was the only one who saw the covered painting's eyes follow him. It happens again every time he passes one of its kind.

So far: On Day 1 the Thornbury took 5 Galleons off him.

Where their story goes:

- Day 1 Curfew: the dream of the painted eye. If you did not use it, use it tonight.
- The covered painting's eyes follow only the Quill. Each time, tell them privately. Let them be the one to warn the others, in their words.
- Mirror Self and the Painted Double are both copies. On Day 4 the Quill may be the only one who can tell the real Ashgrove from the painted one.

Playing to them: Wide-eyed, clever, a bit out of their depth. Let them notice what nobody else does, and let the table hear it from them, not from you.

> **IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS**
>
> *"A Muggle-born? How marvellous. Do your parents still use those little metal drills? Tell me everything."*

Rose Sinclair

Played by Rose Magnus. Ravenclaw. Half-blood, a comfortable vault.

Rolls	STR +2 · DEX +1 · CON +2 · INT +3 · WIS +0 · CHA −1
HP	22 at full health
Carries	Vine wand with a unicorn hair core (seeks a hidden purpose, +4 mana). A Kneazle (+1 WIS, +1 CHA, senses untrustworthy people). Annotated books. Knows Stupefy from home. A key in the family vault.
House trait	**Wit.** +2 INT (already in the numbers). Once a day they can tap **Ask for a hint** on a puzzle, and you give one. A hint is a nudge, not the answer: point at the right object, or confirm one letter.

Family ability: Constant Vigilance

Always	Auror training at home: they cannot be caught by surprise, and they started the game knowing Stupefy.
Once a day	Re-roll any d20 in a fight and keep the better roll.
Drawback	They do not back down. When someone insults their family, they need a WIS roll (12) to walk away.

When they use it:

An ambush or surprise attack	Never surprised. They act first in the first round, even if everyone else is caught off guard. Tell them: “You saw it a second before it moved.”
They re-roll in a fight (once a day)	Any d20 in a fight: an attack, a defence, a saving roll. Keep the better one. Not outside a fight.
Stupefy	Their opening spell. 1d8, rolled with INT. They had it from the start, so they can teach the others how it feels.
Someone insults their family	WIS roll, 12. Fail: they have to answer it (a sharp word, a shove, a duel challenge). Use Cassius or a Slytherin prefect to push it.
Day 2 Curfew: their sister is drained	Everything about that scene belongs to them. Let them choose first: who to tell, whether to stay, what to promise.

Secret gift: Fashionably Late

Always	They are late for everything. But the castle bends around it: they always turn up exactly when things get interesting.
Once a day	Burst into a scene or a fight that has already started, wherever the others are. In a fight they join at the start of the next round, and their first spell gets +2 to hit.
Drawback	At every morning class roll a d20 for them. On 1 to 6 they are late: −5 house points, and the teacher remembers their name for the wrong reasons.

When they use it:

They burst in (once a day)	Anywhere, no matter where they were. Describe the doors banging open. In a fight: next round, +2 to hit with the first spell.
When to suggest it	When the others are in trouble and the Sinclair was elsewhere. It solves splitting the party.
The morning roll (1 to 6)	Late: −5 house points, and the teacher says their name in a disappointed voice. On 7 or more they are on time, and everyone notices.
Late on purpose, to skip something	Let it work, but the teacher remembers. The next time they are late, it costs 10 points.

Who they are

A family of Aurors. Both parents hunt dark wizards for the Ministry and are rarely home. Their older sister is a Ravenclaw prefect, and Rose has always been the one following her into rooms. Tough, direct, and the first to step in front of a friend.

The family secret: Their sister wrote home that the castle "feels wrong this year" and asked Rose to keep an eye out. She is the only one the sister told.

So far: On Day 1 Rose rolled a natural 20 on the Library chest (15 Galleons, a Focus Draught and a Remembrall), and the party took on her sister's quest and walked the patrol route. Her diary noticed her sister having bad dreams about paintings, a key in the family vault (and a goblin who looked at her in a certain way), and guessed that houses with high points get a perk or a clue (right).

Where their story goes:

- Day 2 Curfew: Prefect Sinclair is found drained. She is the first victim. Give Rose quiet moments with her before then, at Lunch and on the Grand Staircase.
- Day 3: someone whispers "Canvas" to Rose. Only her.
- The vault key: an owl from home can say "It was your great-aunt's. Keep it close." What it opens is yours to decide.
- When the sister wakes (if she wakes), she remembers only one thing, and she tells Rose.

Playing to them: Protective and fierce, never backs down. Give her someone to protect, and test her with insults.

> **IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS**
>
> *"A Sinclair? Your mother arrested my nephew. He deserved it. Carry on."*

John Thornbury

Played by Nathaniel. Ravenclaw. Half-blood, a modest vault.

Rolls	STR +1 · DEX +0 · CON +2 · INT +1 · WIS +2 · CHA +1
HP	22 at full health
Carries	Vine wand with a phoenix feather core (+1 spell damage). A Rat (+1 DEX). Annotated books. A Gold cauldron (an extra dose of every potion). The first rune tablet.
House trait	**Wit.** +2 INT (already in the numbers). Once a day they can tap **Ask for a hint** on a puzzle, and you give one. A hint is a nudge, not the answer: point at the right object, or confirm one letter.

Family ability: Beast Bond

Always	Magical creatures never attack them first, and they roll with advantage to calm or befriend one.
Once a day	Ask a creature what it has seen. It answers in feelings and images you describe.
Drawback	They cannot stand to see a creature hurt, and will risk themselves to stop it.

When they use it:

A creature in a fight	It never attacks the Thornbury first. Once the Thornbury attacks it, that protection ends for that creature.
Calming or befriending	Advantage, always. A good roll and the creature is on their side for the scene.
They ask a creature what it saw (once a day)	Answer in feelings and images, not words: “Cold. A smell of paint. Two-legs carrying something heavy. Fear.”
Someone hurts a creature	They must step in (no roll to choose not to). If the table is about to kill a creature, let the Thornbury try to calm it first.
Monsters that are not creatures	Mimics, the Painted Double, animated armour: Beast Bond does not work on them. Tell them: “It is not alive the way animals are.”
Bramble (Day 3 onwards)	Their lost hippogriff. In the Forbidden Forest only the Thornbury can get close. Asked what she has seen: “The dark under the castle. Something that is not a person.”

Secret gift: Rat-Speech

Always	They can talk to rats. Rats know every crack, pipe and pantry in the castle.
Once a day	Send a rat to listen in a room or follow someone for one block. At the start of the next block, you tell them what it heard.
Drawback	Rats are cowards and gossips: on a d20 of 1 to 5 it also tells someone else what they asked. And the caretaker’s cat can smell rat on them, so after curfew they roll Stealth with disadvantage.

When they use it:

They send a rat (once a day)	Next block, a short report in rat voice: “Big man. Angry. Said ‘tonight’. Dropped cheese. Good cheese.”
The gossip roll (1 to 5)	The rat also tells someone: Filch, Peeves, or the person it was spying on. Next block, that person knows the Thornbury was asking.
After curfew	Stealth with disadvantage. Mrs Norris finds them first, always.
Their own rat familiar	It is the first rat they talk to. Give it a name and a personality (nervous, greedy, loyal).
Rats near the covered painting	They refuse. Like the spiders, they will not go near it. That refusal is a clue.

Who they are

Creature breeders from the Welsh hills. John could calm a hippogriff before he could read, and animals trust him on sight. Not the most book-smart, but nobody in the party reads a room (or a creature) faster.

The family secret: Last year the family's prize hippogriff, Bramble, vanished near the Forbidden Forest. Nobody believed John when he said he heard her calling.

So far: On Day 1 John found the first rune tablet, took 5 Galleons from his friend the Quill, and had his tarot read (a curse that cost 20 Galleons, and the Favour of Pentacles).

Where their story goes:

- From Day 1 they can hear something large and frightened deep in the forest. From Day 3 (Scamander's lesson) Bramble is findable.
- Bringing Bramble home is one of the best endings for the Thornbury. She knows the way under the castle.
- The rune tablets: he found the first. Let him carry it and be the one to hold it up when the next one lights.

Playing to them: Quiet, steady, more at home with animals than people. Give him the scenes where the creatures are the point.

> **IN CHARACTER: A PORTRAIT, AS THEY PASS**
>
> *"Oh, do come here, boy. You smell of rats and hay and honesty. How refreshing."*